University of Jena
Department of English and American Studies
Winter 2018-19

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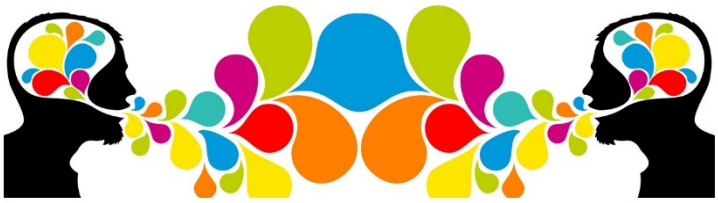
Second Language Acquisition

BA.AA.SW08
Monday, 16 - 18 pm
Carl-Zeiß-Straße 3, SR 122
5 ECTS



Seminar Description

> *Hardly one besides the father, the head of the family spoke German. Nevertheless, they were all friendly smiling at me and motioned me in their house. I was offered a seat and Turkish food and drink specialties. The children sat to my feet, listened to me talking German as if I was telling them the most thrilling and entertaining fairy-tale they had ever listened to.*
>
> (ICLE-AUG-0066.1)
>
> (An adult native user of German writes in English about talking in German to child native users of Turkish at their family's place.)

In this seminar, we will be concerned with the processes of acquiring a language in addition to one's native language. As the quote above illustrates, second language acquisition (SLA) is an extremely complex object of investigation. Therefore, we will cover not all but only selected parts of this highly diverse debate. In particular, we will address phenomena which highlight the dynamic, systemic and usage-based nature of SLA. This way, we will learn about the cognitive processes underlying not only SLA but language learning in general. Towards the end of the semester, the seminar will introduce methodological basics of SLA research and we will attempt to conduct some modest-sized empirical studies in preparation for the seminar papers. A final note: Even though SLA research is related to language pedagogy and cross-cultural communication studies, we will not explicitly address them. The seminar rather intends to outline the psycholinguistic background in which future teachers might ground their teaching methods and didactic decisions.

Requirements, weekly preparations and grading system

Your final grade will depend on the seminar paper only (submission deadlines 03-29-2019 and 05-29-2019). Moreover, to be admitted to the seminar paper, a visible commitment to the seminar (continual and active participation, etc.) and weekly preparation in the form of readings and accompanying homework will be required.

The course management system

You find readings and materials on the online platform of our department, WORDWISE. Important information on the organisation of the course will also be distributed via WORDWISE (to your email address). Please enroll in this seminar on WORDWISE (the password was announced in class) and stay updated.

Date	Topic	Preparatory reading	Homework
10-15-2018	Introduction		
10-22-2018	Theoretical positions in SLA	Mitchell et al. (2013), ch. 1	
	Dynamic system aspects of SLA		Send me a question (50-100 signs) about one paper from each of the four key topics. Write what troubled you about the paper, what you thought was particular good/bad, etc. Altogether, you need to write four questions. Some of your questions will be discussed in class. The questions are due on Monday, 12 noon.
10-29-2018	Language as an ever-changing system: language attrition	Hansen and Chen (2001)	
11-05-2018	Language and cognition in interaction: linguistic relativity	Stutterheim and Carroll (2006)	
	Multilingual minds		
11-12-2018	First language effects on second language: sentence acceptability	Hoffmann (2013)	
11-19-2018	Second language effects on first language: sentence parsing	Dussias and Sagarra (2007)	
	Developing systems		
11-26-2018	Input effects in second language learning: frequency	Wolter and Yamashita (2018)	
12-03-2018	Input effects in second language learning: recency	Hwang et al. (2018)	
	The learner and the other		
12-10-2018	The role of learner characteristics: age	Hartshorne et al. (2018)	
12-17-2018	The role of feedback and instructions	Mackey (2006)	
Break			
	SLA explored		
01-07-2019	Methods in SLA research	Mackey and Gass (2005), ch. 3	
01-14-2019	Design of SLA research		Data collection
01-21-2019	Basic statistics in SLA research		Data analysis
01-28-2019	Presentation and discussion of data		
02-04-2019	On writing a seminar paper and conclusion	Schmidtke-Bode (ms)	

References

Dussias, Paola E. and NuriaHilpert Sagarra (2007). "The effect of exposure on syntactic parsing in Spanish–English bilinguals". In: *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition* 10.1, pp. 101–116.

Hansen, Lynne and Yung-Lin Chen (2001). "What counts in the acquisition and attrition of numeral classifiers". In: *JALT Journal* 23.1, pp. 83–100.

Hartshorne, Joshua K., Joshua B. Tenenbaum, and Steven Pinker (2018). "A critical period for second language acquisition: Evidence from 2/3 million English speakers". In: *Cognition* 177, pp. 263–277. DOI: 10.1016/j.cognition.2018.04.007. URL: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2018.04.007.

Hoffmann, Thomas (2013). "Obtaining introspective acceptability judgements". In: *Research Methods in Language Variation and Change*. Ed. by M. Krug and J. Schlüter. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, pp. 99–118. DOI: 10.1017/CBO9780511792519.008.

Hwang, Heeju, Jeong-Ah Shin, and Robert J. Hartsuiker (2018). "Late Bilinguals Share Syntax Unsparingly Between L1 and L2: Evidence From Crosslinguistically Similar and Different Constructions". In: *Language Learning*, n/a–n/a. ISSN: 1467-9922. DOI: 10.1111/lang.12272.

Mackey, Alison (2006). "Feedback, noticing and instructed second language learning". In: *Applied linguistics* 27.3, pp. 405–430.

Mackey, Alison and Susan M. Gass (2005). *Second language research: Methodology and design*. Routledge.

Mitchell, Rosamond, Florence Myles, and Emma Marsden (2013). *Second language learning theories*. Routledge.

Schmidtke-Bode, Karsten (ms). "Practical Guidelines for Writing a Paper in Linguistics". online. Jena.

Stutterheim, Christiane von and Mary Carroll (2006). "The impact of grammatical temporal categories on ultimate attainment in L2 learning". In: *Educating for advanced foreign language capacities: Constructs, curriculum, instruction, assessment*. Ed. by Heather D. Weger-Guntharp and Katherine A. Sprang. Georgetown University Press, pp. 40–53.

Wolter, Brent and Junko Yamashita (2018). "Word frequency, collocational frequency, L1 congruency, and proficiency in L2 collocational processing". In: *Studies in Second Language Acquisition* 40.2, pp. 395–416. DOI: 10.1017/s0272263117000237. URL: https://doi.org/10.1017/s0272263117000237.

Note: I reserve the right to alter this syllabus (dates, readings, assignments, et. al.) during the semester when I deem it necessary.